

Where We Are: adding events by message

In the app: tap the green **+** **Add** button (bottom right, every page). Type, speak or paste. A preview shows what will happen; press **Add** (and **Undo** if needed). Tap **?** for these rules.

In Slack: post in **#where-we-are** (or DM the Where We Are app). The bot replies in a thread with **Edit** and **Undo** buttons. Both use exactly the same rules.

Top tips: always say a **day** · say **am** or **pm** for anything from 7 to 11 ("Beavers Mon 7.30pm"); 12–6 is always afternoon · **check the preview** before Add and tap the Who / Kids / am-pm chips to fix it.

1. Adding an event

Write **what** · **who** · **day** · **time** · **where**, in any order.

You type	You get
Percy swimming Thu 4-5	Swimming · Percy · Thu 16:00–17:00 · David
Beavers meeting Mon 7pm at scout hut	Beavers meeting at scout hut · Mon 19:00–20:00
Dentist Bernie 14 Oct half 3	Dentist · Bernie · 14 Oct 15:30–16:30
Ashley drop Percy tomorrow 8:45	Drop-off · Percy · 08:45 · Ashley
Legoland all day tomorrow for the family	All day · Bernie & Percy · David & Ashley
Beavers camp Sat 6pm to Sun 9am	Sat 18:00 → Sun 09:00 (one entry per day)
Cornwall 20-24 Oct for the family	All day, 20–24 Oct · Bernie & Percy · David & Ashley
Bernie football every Saturday 10am	Weekly for 8 weeks
Percy swimming Tuesdays 4-5 until 15 Dec	Every Tuesday up to 15 Dec

2. Who it's for

If you say	It means
Nobody named	It's yours (whoever posted it)
Ashley or Joy	They're doing it
both of us / us / we / me and Ashley	David & Ashley, no kids
the family / all of us / everyone	David, Ashley, Bernie & Percy
A kid's name	Tags Bernie and/or Percy

3. Days, times and repeats

Days	today, tomorrow, Mon, next Tues, Friday week, the Saturday after next, in 2 weeks, a week tomorrow, 14 Oct, 4/10
Times	3pm, 4-5, 8:45, half 4, quarter past 3, quarter to 5, noon, all day
am / pm	A plain 7–11 is morning , a plain 12–6 is afternoon . For the evening write 7pm or say tonight . Dinner, drinks, pub, cinema, theatre, bedtime are pm automatically. 730 / 7 30 / 7.30 / 19:30 all work.
Length	No end time means it lasts 1 hour . Over several days: from 6pm on 10 Oct to 9am on 11 Oct, Fri 6 until Sat 10, 20-24 Oct .
Repeats	every Tuesday, Tuesdays, every other Friday, for 6 weeks, until 15 Dec. Without an end, it runs for 8 weeks.

Changing and asking

In the app, type these into Quick add. It shows **before** → **after** and you press **Change** or **Remove**; **Undo** puts it back.

4. Changing an event (app)

Type	Does
move swimming to Friday	Moves it; a weekly series moves together. "Friday" = the Friday in that event's own week
make swimming 5pm	New time (keeps the length)
change swimming to Ashley	New person (or: me, both of us)
rename swimming to Swim club	New name
cancel Legoland	Removes it (all upcoming entries with that name)
cancel swimming on 6 Oct	Removes just that day

5. Asking (app)

Ask	Answers with
what's on tomorrow?	Everything that day, including school runs
what's on this week? / next week / at the weekend	The whole range, grouped by day
who's doing pickup Friday?	Just the school runs
what's Percy doing Saturday?	Just Percy's things

6. Changing in Slack: reply in the event's thread

Reply	Does
5pm · 4-6 · half 5	New time
move to Fri	New day (a series moves together)
Ashley's doing it · me · both of us	Changes who it's for
rename to Scout meeting	New name
cancel	Deletes it (or press Undo)

Or tap **Edit** for a form, or type **/event** in Slack for a blank one.

7. Handy extras (app)

- **Fix before adding:** tap the **Who** chips (Me / Ashley / Joy / Both), **Kids** chips and **am** / **pm** on the preview.
- **Speak it:** tap — "Percy swimming Thursday four till five" works. Or use the keyboard mic.
- **Paste:** the clipboard button takes the sentence with a date from a pasted email or message.
- **Recent:** things you've added recently appear as one-tap chips.
- **Share (Android):** Share → Where We Are opens Quick add pre-filled.
- **Help:** tap ? in the Quick add panel to see these rules in the app.

Tips: always include a day. Only the person who added an event can change it. To delete, use Undo, "cancel ...", or the app — not Google Calendar. Family events show as "(David & Ashley)" in the Life calendar.

The rules, for review

Every rule the app and Slack bot apply, in order. Tell us which to change.

Reading the message

- Slack formatting (*bold*, _italic_) is ignored.
- Spoken numbers become digits when they're clearly times: "four till five" → 4-5, "seven p.m." → 7pm, "four thirty" → 4:30, "ten o'clock" → 10. "In two weeks" / "for six weeks" are left alone.
- "half 4" = 4:30 (British), "quarter past 3" = 3:15, "quarter to 5" = 4:45, noon / midday = 12:00.

Times

- A bare hour with no am/pm: **7–11 = morning**, **12 and 1–6 = afternoon**. 13–23 are read as 24-hour.
- Evening words (dinner, supper, drinks, pub, cinema, film, theatre, show, concert, gig, date night, bedtime, sleepover, evening, night, takeaway) make a bare hour pm; breakfast / brunch make it am. Not "party" — kids' parties are usually daytime.
- Dictated times: "730", "7 30", "1930" are read as 7:30 / 19:30. "Oct 10" is 10 October (never 2010).
- In the app, an **am / pm** chip on the preview swaps the guess.
- "tonight", "this evening", "this afternoon", "in the evening" make bare hours pm; "this morning", "in the morning" make them am. The "this..." and "tonight" forms also mean today.
- A range ("2-4pm", "9 to 11", "2 till 4") uses the end's am/pm for the start too. If the end would be before the start, it's moved 12 hours later.
- Only a start time → the event lasts **1 hour**. No time, or "all day" → all-day event.
- A number straight after a month ("Oct 3") or with st/nd/rd/th, or in 4/10, is a date, not a time.

Days

- A day is required; without one the app asks "Which day is that?".
- today, tomorrow; a bare weekday = the next one, **including today** ("Thu" on a Thursday = today).
- "next Tues" = the Tuesday in **next** week (Mon–Sun), never this week. "Friday week" = next Friday + 7 days. "the Saturday after next" = skip the coming Saturday.
- "in 3 days", "in two weeks", "a week today", "a week tomorrow".
- Dates: "14 Oct", "Oct 14", "14th October", "4/10" (day/month). Dates always look forward.
- Several weekdays ("Thu and Fri") create one event on each.

Repeats

- "every", "each", "weekly", or a plural day name ("Tuesdays") = weekly. "every other", "fortnightly" = every 2 weeks.
- Runs for **8 weeks** unless "for N weeks" or "until <date>" ("until Christmas" = 25 Dec) is given. Maximum 40 entries.

Multi-day

- A start and finish on different days ("from 6pm on 10 Oct to 9am on 11 Oct", "Sat 6pm to Sun 9am", "Fri 6 until Sat 10", "20-24 Oct") becomes **one entry per day**: first day from the start time to 23:59, middle days all day, last day 00:00 to the finish. Each entry notes the full span. Maximum 31 days.
- "Sat 10 until 13 Dec" is read as weekly on Saturdays at 10 until 13 Dec, not as 10–13 Dec.

Who

- Kids named in the message are tagged (Bernie, Percy). "the family", "all of us", "everyone" tag both kids.
- Assignee: nobody named → **whoever sent it**. A helper (Joy) or one adult (Ashley) named → them.
- "me and Ashley", "both of us", "us", "we", or the family words → **shared** (All Family): no single assignee, shown as David & Ashley.
- Names are matched against the app's People, Helpers and Kids lists, so spell them as they appear there.

Title

- The title is what's left after removing days, times, names and "me/I".
- Linking words left dangling are dropped ("meeting for me at 7pm on Monday at scout hut" → "Meeting at scout hut"). Filler at the start/end (the, a, to, for, with, taking...) is trimmed.
- drop / drop off / drop-off → **Drop-off**; pick up / pickup / collect → **Pickup**; any other words go to notes. Nothing left → "Event".

Changing (app)

- A message starting with move / reschedule / push / shift / change / make / rename / cancel / delete / remove / scrap is a change. The words before "to" pick the event: matched against upcoming titles (next 6 months) plus kid names. A day in that part narrows to that day.
- If several different events match, it asks which. If nothing matches and it started with "make" or "change", it's treated as a new event instead ("Make cakes for the fair Fri").
- A plain weekday in "move ... to Fri" means that weekday in the event's own week; never moved into the past.

Asking (app)

- A message starting with what / who / when / anything / is there / do we / show me, or ending with "?", is a question. Range: the day(s) mentioned, "this week", "next week", "weekend"; otherwise today.
- Mentioning pickup / drop-off shows only school runs; mentioning a kid shows only their things.

Life calendar

- Each event goes to the shared Life calendar as "Title — Kids (Who)"; family/shared events show "(David & Ashley)".
- Each person's daily availability is one all-day entry, kept in step with the app (duplicates are removed).

Changing (Slack thread replies)

- "cancel", "delete", "remove", "scrap", "called off" → delete. A new time → change time (keeps the length if only a start is given). A new day → move (a series shifts by the same number of days).
- A name / "me" / "both of us" → reassign. "rename to ...", "change to ...", "call it ..." → new title.
- "thanks", "ok" and thumbs-up are ignored. Only the person who added an event can change or undo it.